

COVER LETTER FOR LETTER OF EXPECTATIONS

Spring 2026

Candidate name:	Piter Garcia
Candidate phone number:	646-628-8300
Candidate email:	pgarcia8@u.rochester.edu
School-Based Teacher Educator name:	Derek Romig
School-Based Teacher Educator phone number:	TBD
School-Based Teacher Educator email address:	derek.romig@greececsd.org
Inclusion School-Based Teacher Educator name:	N/A — inclusion supervision provided by university
Inclusion School-Based Teacher Educator phone:	N/A
Inclusion School-Based Teacher Educator email:	N/A
School name and address:	Pine Brook Elementary, Greece Central School District, Rochester, NY
School telephone number:	TBD
University-Based Teacher Educator name:	Zenon (Zen) Borys — Computer Science
University-Based Teacher Educator phone number:	585-259-9598
University-Based Teacher Educator email:	zborys@warner.rochester.edu
Inclusion University-Based Teacher Educator name:	Sue Maddamma — Inclusion / Special Education
Inclusion University-Based Teacher Educator phone number:	TBD
Inclusion University-Based Teacher Educator email:	suemaddamma@gmail.com

Acknowledgement

All parties have read and agree with the objectives and requirements outlined in this Letter of Expectations and have read the entire Student Teaching Handbook.

Candidate: _____	Date: _____
School-Based Teacher Educator: _____	Date: _____
Inclusion School-Based Teacher Educator: _____	Date: _____
University-Based Teacher Educator: _____	Date: _____
Inclusion Univ-Based Teacher Educator: _____	Date: _____

LETTER OF EXPECTATIONS

Spring 2026

Effective date: February 8, 2026

Target submission date: February 8, 2026 (two weeks after placement start)

Purpose: This document clarifies schedule commitments, roles, communication norms, lesson plan expectations, meeting and observation routines, and contingency procedures for the field experience and student teaching placement.

1 General Expectations

This placement follows a graduated release-of-responsibility model across two phases:

Phase 1 — Observation & Assistantship (150+ hours, Feb–mid-Apr 2026):

- Learn the classroom context, students, routines, and IGNITE curriculum (CS, design thinking, robotics, coding).
- Observe instruction and document professional learning through structured notes and reflections.
- Support students one-on-one and in small groups; assist with lesson preparation, materials, and formative checks.
- Co-teach lesson segments and mini-lessons with increasing scope.
- Develop practice skills—differentiation, UDL-informed supports, and culturally and disability-responsive pedagogy.

Phase 2 — Student Teaching (5 weeks / 25 instructional days, mid-Apr–Jun 2026):

- Assume primary or co-teaching responsibility for lessons and units.
- Plan and deliver full lesson sequences, including differentiation and inclusive supports.
- Implement formative and summative assessments; analyze results to adjust instruction.
- Manage classroom routines with support from the cooperating teacher.
- Collect evidence and artifacts for CPAST evaluation and reflective practice.

Candidate learning goals:

1. **Planning & alignment:** Produce weekly plans with clear learning targets aligned to standards/curriculum.
2. **Inclusive instruction:** Implement uniform differentiation supports (scaffolds, choice, multimodal representations).
3. **Assessment & adjustment:** Use at least one formative check per lesson block; document one instructional adjustment per week based on evidence.
4. **Digital tools in CS learning:** Integrate age-appropriate tools to support coding/CS learning and collaboration.
5. **Reflective practice:** Weekly reflection notes tying instruction to research and identifying one improvement action.

2 Specific Requirements

2.1 Candidate

- **Observation:** Maintain structured observation notes focused on instructional strategies, classroom management, student engagement, differentiation, and the IGNITE curriculum. Document reflections weekly.
- **Lesson planning:** Submit a weekly planning packet to Derek by Friday for the following week. Packet includes: learning targets/objectives, lesson outline, inclusion/differentiation plan (UDL supports, scaffolds, accommodations), formative checks, materials list, and an assessment artifact (exit ticket, rubric, quiz, or reflection prompt).
- **Teaching:** Phase 1—co-teach lesson segments and lead small-group instruction. Phase 2—plan and deliver full lessons/units with increasing independence.

- **Assessment:** Use at least one routine formative check per lesson block; document at least one instructional adjustment per week based on evidence. Implement summative assessments as appropriate during Phase 2.
- **Parent/admin contact:** Follow school policy; all parent communication goes through Derek. Maintain strict confidentiality of student information.
- **Collaboration:** Work with grade-level teams, specialists, and support staff as directed by Derek. Participate in staff meetings and professional development when present.
- **Administrative/after-school duties:** Arrive on time for committed blocks; assist with arrival/dismissal routines as requested. No after-school duties are required, but candidate may voluntarily participate.
- **One-on-one instruction:** Tutor individual students or provide targeted support as identified by Derek.
- **Professional conduct:** Maintain professional conduct, confidentiality, boundaries, and timely communication.
- **Evidence portfolio:** Maintain an organized collection of lesson plans, observation notes, reflections, assessment artifacts, and de-identified student work throughout the semester.
- **Midpoint self-evaluation:** Complete the Warner_MidpointEval form as a self-evaluation at approximately 75 placement hours (midpoint of Phase 1). Sit down with Derek to compare evaluations side by side and discuss perceptions of progress. The five weeks of student teaching cannot begin until this form is submitted.
- **Final self-assessment (CPAST):** The CPAST rubric is the candidate's final student teaching assessment. At the end of the placement, the candidate will self-assess using the CPAST rubric, then participate in a three-way conference (with Derek and Zenon) where all three parties individually rate performance, discuss ratings, work to reach consensus scores, and articulate growth goals. To support consistent scoring, all three participants complete the brief CPAST online training prior to the final conference.

2.2 School-Based Teacher Educator (Derek Romig)

- **Orientation:** Introduce Piter to classroom routines, school procedures, the IGNITE curriculum (CS, design thinking, robotics, coding), and district/building policies.
- **Modeling & coaching:** Demonstrate lessons and instructional strategies; co-plan lessons with Piter; provide regular verbal and written coaching feedback.
- **Observations:** Observe the candidate informally weekly and formally before each university supervisor visit. Share observation notes and actionable feedback promptly.
- **Liaison:** Facilitate introductions to other teachers, administrators, specialists, and parents. All parent/guardian communication flows through Derek.
- **Midpoint evaluation:** Complete the Warner_MidpointEval form for the candidate at approximately 75 placement hours. Sit down with Piter to compare evaluations (Derek's and Piter's self-evaluation) side by side and discuss progress. Submit Derek's copy to Zenon by email (zborys@warner.rochester.edu). Suggested filename: Garcia_Romig_Spring2026MIDPOINT.pdf.
- **CPAST training & final assessment:** Complete the CPAST online training (60–90 min, 85% passing score required). At the end of the placement, individually rate Piter using the CPAST rubric, participate in the three-way conference to reach consensus scores, and submit Derek's completed CPAST rubric (with any notes) to Zenon.
- **Gradual release:** Provide increasing opportunity for the candidate to assume instructional responsibility, from co-teaching segments to full lesson leadership.

2.3 University-Based Teacher Educators (Zenon Borys & Sue Maddamma)

- **Observation/visit cadence:** Zenon Borys (CS) will conduct 2–3 visits during the semester: one during Phase 1 (field experience) and 1–2 during Phase 2 (student teaching). Sue Maddamma (Inclusion) will coordinate with Zenon and join periodically for inclusion-focused feedback.
- **Feedback & coaching:** After each observation, the supervisor(s) will meet with the candidate and Derek as soon as possible to debrief. Written observation notes and actionable feedback will be provided.

- **Midpoint conference:** At approximately 75 placement hours, Zenon will meet with Derek and Piter to review the midpoint evaluation (Derek’s assessment + Piter’s self-evaluation) and discuss progress. The five-week student teaching phase cannot begin until this form is submitted.
- **CPAST training & final assessment:** The CPAST rubric is Piter’s final student teaching assessment. Prior to the final conference, Zenon completes the CPAST online training (and confirms completion for all participants who will rate using the rubric). At the end of the placement, Zenon will facilitate a three-way conference (via Zoom) where Derek, Piter, and Zenon each individually rate Piter’s performance, discuss ratings, work to reach consensus scores for each category, and articulate goals for Piter’s growth. After the conference, Zenon submits the consensus scores as required and Derek submits his completed CPAST rubric with notes to Zenon.
- **Availability between visits:** Zenon is available by email (zborys@warner.rochester.edu) and phone (585-259-9598). Sue coordinates with Zenon. If questions or concerns emerge outside scheduled visits, either party should contact the supervisor promptly.
- **Documentation:** Supervisors coordinate all required documentation submission processes, including midpoint and final evaluation forms.

3 Schedule

3.1 Daily Schedule Expectations

The candidate is simultaneously enrolled in required graduate coursework at RIT and UofR. The schedule below reflects a stable weekly commitment that balances consistent placement presence, safety, and sustainable commuting, and coursework responsibilities.

Day	Placement Presence	Notes
Monday	1:10 PM – 3:10 PM	Afternoon block (after RIT lectures)
Tuesday	9:00 AM – 3:20 PM	Full day
Wednesday	1:10 PM – 3:10 PM	Afternoon block (after RIT lectures)
Thursday	9:00 AM – 3:20 PM	Full day
Friday	9:10 AM – 3:10 PM	Full day

Weekly total (target): ~22 hours/week of placement presence.

Check-in procedure: Sign in at the front office upon arrival; report directly to Derek’s classroom.

Scheduling constraints: If an accommodation is required for a specific week (e.g., special seminar dates), the candidate will communicate and confirm the plan in advance with Derek and Zenon.

3.2 Student Teaching Commitments

1. **When will the candidate begin to assume partial or full responsibility?**
Partial responsibility (co-teaching segments, small-group instruction) begins during Phase 1 and increases gradually. Full responsibility begins at the start of Phase 2 (~mid-April 2026), contingent on a passing midpoint evaluation and submission of this Letter of Expectations.
2. **Which classes will the candidate co-teach with the SBTE?**
The candidate will co-teach IGNITE program sessions (computer science, design thinking, robotics, and coding lessons) across grade levels served by Derek’s classroom.
3. **Which classes will the candidate observe?**
During Phase 1, the candidate will observe all of Derek’s instructional periods, including transitions, morning routines (Tue/Thu/Fri full days), and afternoon blocks (Mon/Wed). Observations focus on pedagogy, classroom management, differentiation, and student engagement.
4. **Transition from less to more instructional responsibility:**
Weeks 1–3: Observation, structured notes, 1:1 and small-group support.
Weeks 4–6: Co-teach lesson segments; lead mini-lessons under Derek’s guidance.
Weeks 7–10: Increase co-teaching scope; begin planning full lessons.
Phase 2 (Weeks 11–16): Candidate leads full lessons/units with Derek providing feedback. Candidate teaches

for 25 instructional days, with options including: leading one class while Derek leads another, co-teaching together, or teaching specific lesson units independently.

3.3 Timeline of responsibilities

Include a timeline of responsibilities over the course of the placement.

Weeks / Dates	Candidate responsibilities	Evidence / checkpoints
Feb 4–14 (Wk 1–2)	Observe instruction; take structured notes; support students 1:1 and in small groups; learn routines and IGNITE curriculum	Observation notes; initial reflections
Feb 17–Mar 7 (Wk 3–5)	Assist with lesson prep and materials; co-teach lesson segments; begin formative checks	1–2 lesson plan artifacts; co-teaching log
Mar 10–28 (Wk 6–8)	Lead mini-lessons; increase co-teaching scope; plan full lessons with Derek's guidance	Lesson plans with differentiation; formative assessment examples
~Mar 15	Midpoint evaluation (~75 hrs): candidate self-assessment + Derek assessment + supervisor conference	Garcia_Romig_Spring2026MIDPOINT.pdf submitted to Zenon
Mar 31–Apr 10 (Wk 9–10)	Continue co-teaching with increasing independence; finalize Phase 2 transition plan	Observation feedback; revised learning goals
~Apr 15–Jun (Phase 2)	Candidate leads full lessons/units (25 instructional days); manages routines; implements assessments; collects CCAST evidence	Weekly lesson plans; formative/summative artifacts; portfolio evidence
Late Apr / May	Final three-way conference (Derek, Piter, Zenon): consensus CCAST ratings and growth planning	Final CCAST rubrics submitted to Zenon

4 Lesson Plans

- **Review frequency:** Weekly. The candidate submits a planning packet to Derek by **Friday end-of-day** for the following week. If a school holiday or major assignment disrupts Friday submission, Derek and the candidate agree on an alternative deadline in advance.
- **Review method:** Shared document (Google Doc or email attachment). Derek reviews the packet before the start of the following week and provides written or verbal feedback.
- **Review focus:** Alignment of learning targets to standards/curriculum; quality of differentiation and inclusive supports (UDL); clarity of formative checks for understanding; materials and technology readiness.
- **Planning packet minimum contents:**
 - Learning targets/objectives (student-friendly wording where appropriate)
 - Outline of lesson flow (opener → modeling → guided practice → independent practice → closure)
 - Inclusion/differentiation plan (scaffolds, accommodations/modifications)
 - Formative checks (what, when, and adjustment plan if students struggle)
 - Materials/tech list (links, handouts, device needs)
 - Assessment artifact (exit ticket, rubric, quiz, reflection prompt, or performance task)

5 Meetings

5.1 Regular Meetings

How often will the candidate and School-Based Teacher Educator(s) meet? When will these meetings take place? What will be the focus?

- **Weekly check-in (15–30 minutes):** Derek and Piter meet once per week (day/time to be agreed, recommended: end of a full teaching day) to:
 - Preview upcoming lessons and confirm roles for co-teaching/support.
 - Address schedule adjustments for the following week.
 - Review feedback from the prior week’s instruction.

5.2 Additional Meetings

Will the candidate and School-Based Teacher Educator(s) be able to meet at other times if the need arises? How will these meetings be arranged?

- Yes. Either party may request an ad hoc meeting via email or text. Meetings will be arranged at a mutually convenient time, typically before or after the placement block.
- Day-to-day classroom questions and logistics should be directed to Derek first.
- For scheduling or evaluation process questions, contact Zenon Borys (CS) or Sue Maddamma (Inclusion).

5.3 Post-Observation Meetings

The candidate, School-Based Teacher Educator(s), and University-Based Teacher Educator will meet as soon as possible after each observation by the University-Based Teacher Educator.

- After each university supervisor observation, Zenon (and/or Sue) will debrief with Derek and Piter as soon as possible—ideally the same day or within 48 hours.
- The debrief will review the lesson observed, discuss strengths and areas for growth, and set specific goals for subsequent instruction.
- Monthly: Zenon visits for observation/feedback; Sue joins periodically for inclusion-focused feedback. All parties review progress toward milestones.

6 Observations

6.1 School-Based Teacher Educator Observations

When will the School-Based Teacher Educator(s) observe the candidate (e.g., before the University-Based Teacher Educator/faculty come to observe)?

- Derek will observe the candidate informally on a **weekly** basis during co-teaching and independent lesson segments.
- Derek will conduct a more structured, formal observation **before** each scheduled university supervisor visit so that feedback can inform the observed lesson.
- Feedback from SBTE observations will be shared verbally (same day) and/or in brief written notes.

6.2 University-Based Teacher Educator Observations

When will the University-Based Teacher Educator observe the candidate teaching lessons during the field experience or student teaching?

- **Zenon Borys (CS):** 2–3 visits total — first observation ~Feb 16–20; one observation during Phase 1; 1–2 observations during Phase 2 (student teaching).
- **Sue Maddamma (Inclusion):** Coordinates with Zenon; joins periodically for observation and feedback.
- **Evidence captured during observations:** Lesson plan for the observed session, supervisor observation notes, candidate post-lesson reflection, and de-identified student work samples where relevant.
- **Suggested evidence cadence (candidate maintains throughout):**
 - 1–2 lesson plans/week saved as PDF
 - 1 formative assessment example/week + resulting adjustment note
 - 1 weekly reflection (what worked, what didn't, what changes next)
 - Periodic photos of non-identifying classroom materials or student-facing instructions

7 Possible Situations / Contingencies

1. What will the candidate do if the SBTE is absent?

The candidate is **not legally permitted** to substitute for the SBTE. If Derek is absent, Piter will report to the assigned substitute teacher or building administrator for direction. The candidate may observe or assist the substitute but will not assume sole classroom responsibility. Piter will notify Zenon of the situation.

2. What will the SBTE do if the candidate is absent?

Derek will proceed with instruction as normal. Any lesson components the candidate was expected to lead will be covered by Derek or reassigned. The candidate will provide an updated plan for missed responsibilities upon return.

3. How will each party inform the other of absences?

The absent party will notify the other as early as possible (ideally the evening before or early morning of the absence) via text/phone for urgent same-day notice and a follow-up email for documentation. The candidate will also notify Zenon Borys of any absence.

4. What will be done in case of snow days or emergencies?

Follow Greece Central School District policy for closures/delays. If the district closes, no placement attendance is required. The candidate will complete an agreed-upon asynchronous task (e.g., reflection writing, lesson planning, or resource review) as arranged with Derek. Any full or partial absences that reduce the candidate's total required hours must be made up with additional time.

Note: Candidates are not legally allowed to substitute for School-Based Teacher Educators during clinical experiences.